



Both of You

Script Library

Every script from all 20 modules, organised by the moment you're in. Not for the calm morning. For the 5pm Tuesday.

adhdreflect.com

HOW TO USE THIS

Nine situations. One script each.

These scripts are not lines to memorise. They're starting points. Use the ones that sound like you. Change the words to yours. The goal is a sentence you can actually say when you have nothing left.

Each section is organised around what's happening right now, not around a module number. Find the moment. Read the note under the script. That's the context.

Print this. Put it where you'll see it before you need to remember it.

- 1 Before you snap
- 2 When both of you are in it
- 3 When the argument won't stop
- 4 After you lost it
- 5 When your child is falling apart
- 6 When you've checked out
- 7 For the partner conversation
- 8 For the school
- 9 The internal script

SECTION 1

Before you snap

The signal arrives 30 seconds before the reaction. Heat in the chest, jaw tightening, shoulders rising. You have a window. This script uses it.

SAY OUT LOUD — THEN MOVE TO A DIFFERENT ROOM

“I need one second.”

Sixty seconds. Not calm, just away from the input that drove you to threshold. Return with fewer words and lower volume. You're not fixing it. You're stopping the amplification.

SAY TO YOURSELF — NOT OUT LOUD

The cup didn't cause it. The full container caused it.

The trigger is rarely the real trigger. This reframe interrupts the shame spiral by naming what actually happened: the stack, not the spark.

SECTION 2

When both of you are in it

Two dysregulated nervous systems in the same room amplify each other. You can't regulate them while you're dysregulated. The only useful move is to reduce the mutual input.

SAY BEFORE LEAVING THE ROOM

“I need a minute. I'll be back.”

This sentence names the withdrawal so it doesn't read as abandonment, and promises return. Leave. Sixty seconds minimum. Come back with fewer words, lower volume, no attempt to resolve yet.

SECTION 3

When the argument won't stop

The loop runs because your brain is chasing closure it can't have right now. Every sentence past the third works against you. The lesson survives the delay. Use one of these. Once. Then move.

CHOOSE ONE. SAY IT ONCE. THEN PHYSICALLY MOVE.

"We're not talking about this right now."

"My answer isn't changing."

"I've said what I needed to say."

Do not repeat the sentence if they push back. Repeating it is re-entering the loop through a different door. The lesson can be delivered calmly twelve hours later. That version actually lands.

12 HOURS LATER — WHEN BOTH OF YOU ARE CALM

"Here's what I was actually trying to say: ____"

Two sentences. The point you were trying to make, delivered in conditions where it can be received. This is not the same conversation. Don't make it the same conversation.

SECTION 4

After you lost it

Two sentences. Delivered when both of you are calm. Not immediately. Before bed is fine. The next morning is fine. Say the two sentences. Then do something ordinary. Don't wait for a response.

IF YOU EXPLODED

“I yelled at you this morning and that wasn't okay. I'm going to work on leaving the room before I get that loud.”

Sentence one names what happened. Sentence two names what you're going to try. Not a promise, a try. Then stop. Don't add context. Two sentences, then something ordinary.

IF YOU SHUT DOWN

“I went quiet and disappeared and that wasn't fair. I'm going to work on coming back sooner instead of waiting until I feel ready.”

The withdrawal repair. Names the specific thing that happened, not the explosion. Same structure: what happened, what I'm going to try.

IF YOU SAID THE THING

“I said something sharp and I shouldn't have. I'm going to work on stopping before I say the thing I don't mean.”

For the words that landed wrong. Pick the repair that fits the actual thing that happened, not the most dramatic version of it.

SECTION 5

When your child is falling apart

Their container was already full when they arrived home. The cup wasn't the cause. The most useful first response acknowledges the feeling without evaluating the trigger. One sentence, then wait.

SAY ONCE — THEN WAIT 30 SECONDS BEFORE DOING ANYTHING ELSE

“That's really upsetting you.”

Not “it's fine.” Not “it's just a biscuit.” Just acknowledgment, then silence. No evaluation of whether the upset is proportionate. The peak always passes. Your job during the peak is to not add input.

SECTION 6

When you've checked out

Naming the shutdown is the difference between an absence your child has to interpret alone and one they can hold with a frame. You don't regulate first and then return. You return, and that's what starts the regulation.

NAME IT BEFORE YOU GO

“I need five minutes. I'll be back.”

Named withdrawals are workable. Unnamed ones leave a gap that fills with your child's interpretation, usually something about themselves.

WHEN YOU RETURN — PICK ONE, OR JUST SIT NEAR THEM SILENTLY FOR 30 SECONDS

“I needed a minute. I’m back.”

“Do you want some water?”

You don't need warmth you don't have. Physical presence is the regulating event, not the readiness that precedes it. Small enough to do when you have nothing left is the only design specification that matters.

SECTION 7

For the partner conversation

They see the match. They don't see what was already burning. The goal isn't one agreed version of what happened. It's understanding that there were two valid accounts.

START HERE — THEN ACTUALLY LISTEN TO THE FULL ANSWER

“What did you see happening just before it went wrong?”

Their answer will be different from yours. Both are real. Don't interrupt to correct. The conversation is about building two versions, not one correct one.

THEN ADD YOUR VERSION — AS INFORMATION, NOT A DEFENCE

“I hear what you saw. What I was managing before that moment was ____.”

“I hear what you saw” signals that you received their account before contributing yours. That order matters.

SECTION 8

For the school conversation

The school observes behaviour. You observe the internal experience that produces it. You're adding a layer of information to their picture of your child, not asking them to change their version.

OPENING THE CONTEXT CONVERSATION

“I understand what you observed. I want to give you some context about what was happening for them before that moment.”

Then one piece of specific, recent context. Not a defence. An explanation of the cause. Something the school can actually use. Over time, that layer accumulates.

WHEN YOU THINK SOMETHING ELSE MAY ALSO BE PRESENT

“There's something I've been noticing about [name] that doesn't quite fit the ADHD picture. Can I describe it and get your thoughts?”

Not a diagnostic label. An observation in specific behavioural terms. That's enough to open the conversation.

SECTION 9

The internal script

What to say to yourself, not out loud. Not affirmations. Structural reframes. Accurate descriptions of what's actually happening that interrupt the shame spiral before it has momentum.

WHEN THE GAP BETWEEN KNOWING AND DOING OPENS UP

I know what I'm supposed to do. I couldn't do it right now. That's the thing I'm working on.

The gap is not a character flaw. It's what happens when the tools don't fit the conditions. The reframe is the first action.

WHEN THE SHAME ARRIVES

This is structural, not personal.

You have been applying tools designed for a different nervous system configuration. That's a design mismatch. Structural problems have structural solutions.

WHEN THE SPIRAL IS RUNNING

I've already counted that. I don't need to count it again.

Rumination is a search for resolution that isn't available inside the spiral. This sentence gives you a foothold when you notice you're three laps in.

ON THE HARD DAYS

Slightly earlier. Not perfectly. Not always.

This is the whole goal. One notch upstream of where you were before. That's real progress, even when it doesn't look like it.

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